DCU
Ollscoil Chathair
Bhaile Átha Cliath
Dublin City University

School of Computing
RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE

APPLICATION FORM FOR ETHICAL REVIEW OF A RESEARCH PROJECT INVOLVING HUMAN PARTICIPANTS WHICH IS IN THE CATEGORY OF NOTIFICATION ONLY

There are 3 generally accepted levels of ethical review for projects carried out in a University or similar setting. These are notification only, expediated and full committee.

This notification only level of review is to approve relatively low-risk research involving human participants, primarily using social science methodologies in which any personal information collected is not of a sensitive nature. The School of Computing Research Ethics Committee has been delegated responsibility by the University to approve ethics submissions from undergraduate and taught Masters projects only, which are in the category of notification only.

Examples of projects in this category include:

- Anonymous surveys in which the topic itself is not likely to elicit significant difficulties for the participants, such as: anonymous internet surveys (e.g. Survey Monkey), street questioning.
- Observation (without audio or visual recording) of public settings where privacy would not normally be expected, such as observing people on streets or at sports events.
- Research carrying no risks beyond those of everyday life (as experienced by the intended participant population), such as asking people's opinions about products or services; asking students about educational experiences; monitoring the impact of daily activities.
- Interviews with public figures, professionals or others in their professional capacity regarding their professional activities.
- Analysis of data (e.g. health records) which have had all identifying information removed by the data holder and been provided to the researcher in accordance with data protection legislation.
- Collection of biological samples which are anonymised and do not require invasive techniques (e.g. hair, nails).

If your project is using data from a public repository like Kaggle or is not generating or using any form of personal data then you do not need research ethics approval, you do not need to complete and to submit this form and your project supervisor should indicate this on the project dashboard.

If your project involves collecting or processing personal data which is of a personal nature, you must first complete the DCU online Data Protection training course and review the "Data Protection – Key Points for DCU Researchers" guidance from the Data Protection Unit to assist you in meeting your legal obligations under GDPR and associated Irish law.

Once you have completed this form (if you need to) you should save it as a PDF file, not WORD, and upload it to the your project dashboard before you start gathering data. It will then be read and assessed by two members of the committee and once two members of the committee approve your submission you will be automatically notified by email and your project can start data gathering.

There are strict deadlines for submitting this form for each class group, undergraduate and taught Masters by which your submission must be made and you will be informed of these deadlines by your course board chair or project co-ordinator. If you do not submit by these deadlines then the research ethics committee is not obliged to approve your submission and when that happens and your project

is assessed and graded at the end of the year, you will be awarded 0 for that component of your project.

SECTION 1 – GENERAL DETAILS

1.1 Project Title

Smart Calendar - extracting and organising scheduling information into structured calendar events

1.2 Applicant Details

Name	Student or Supervisor	E-mail
Theo Robin	Student	theo.robin2@mail.dcu.ie
Amaru Előd Frisancho	Student	amaru.frisancho2@mail.dcu.ie
David Sinclair	Supervisor	david.sinclair@dcu.ie

Other Investigators: *Including any external to DCU*

Name	School/Unit/External Institution	E-mail

1.3 Key Project Dates

Proposed start date for data collection	Proposed end date for data collection	Proposed project completion date
18/02/2026	20/02/2026	20/02/2026

1.4 Please indicate which academic award

Undergraduate ☒	Taught Masters ☐

1.5 Please confirm the location(s) where the research will be carried out

If research will be carried out abroad, you will need to address the ethical challenges raised by this in Section 3 of your application - consult the Conducting Research Abroad document in the Ethics Resources and Guidelines section of the DCU Research Ethics webpage).

Dublin, Ireland

1.6 Please state what additional permissions may be required to access participants.

Specify from whom the permission is required (e.g. a school Board of Management), and when their written approval will be obtained

SECTION 2 – PROJECT DESIGN AND METHODOLOGY

Research Overview - Please respect the indicated word counts in the following sections and explain all acronyms in full text the first time they appear.

2.1 Provide a brief description of the research (max 250 words):
Please use lay language, include the scientific/theoretical background of study and a justification as to why this research project should proceed in that context

The objective our user testing would be to measure how users with basic computer knowledge are able to navigate our application and to record any issues they may face.
These records would then be used to further improve our system to minimize the number of errors any given user can encounter.

2.2 Please state the aims and objectives of the project (max 200 words)

Our project is a smart calendar designed to help the everyday user collect, unify, and organize their timetables from different forms and sources.
The target audience of our calendar are users who interact with computers/technology on a daily basis and are relatively familier with similar systems.

2.3 Please confirm your methods of data collection:
Tick all relevant check boxes and provide details for each one, including any devices used to collect data, and whether the data will be anonymous, potentially identifiable or identifiable <u>at point of collection</u>

Method	Describe briefly
☐ Interviews or focus groups	
☒ Surveys/questionnaires	Basic survey following user testing to gauge user opinion, as well as any difficulties they might have encountered
☐ Audio/video recordings	
☐ Public observations	
☐ Persons in public office	
☐ Using existing data (incl. secondary data)	
☐ Using human derived material (biological samples)	
☐ Standard tests (educational/personality etc.)	
☐ Standard educational practices	
☒ Other (please specify)	Standard user tests of our calendar application. Testing basic functionality

	Interacting with the calendar, uploading files, creating/editing/deletingevents

2.4 Please confirm who the participants on this study will be, including group size and composition:
Include associated demographic characteristics, and state how your proposed sample size was determined (e.g. power analysis)

Individual users, most likely other students, friends, family members.

2.5 Please outline your recruitment process, including where you are sourcing participants from and your criteria for inclusion/exclusion:
Where gatekeepers are involved, outline the procedures relating to their involvement

Users should have basic computer knowledge. As the calendar is aimed at students/people who work on their computers, we aim to recruit people from such fields. That is our only major criteria

2.6 Addressing participant vulnerability – if your participants fall into any of the following categories, please check the relevant tick box/boxes and state below what special arrangements will be made to protect them:
If your participants are not in any of these categories, tick N/A

☒ N/A
☐ Children under 18 years of age
☐ Persons in unequal relationships with the researcher *(e.g. lecturer-student, therapist-client, employer-employee)*
☐ People with a recognised or diagnosed intellectual, physical or mental impairment
☐ People confined to institutions *(e.g. prisoners, residents in 24 hr nursing facilities)*
☐ People who have undergone traumatic or adverse emotional events
☐ People with diminished cognitive ability
☐ Marginalised sections of society
☐ Other (please specify)

Special arrangements:

2.7 Involvement of children under 18 years of age – if your participants are in this category, please confirm compliance with the following:
If your participants are not in this category, tick N/A

☒ N/A
☐ We confirm that we have read and agree to act in accordance with the DCU Child Protection policy and procedures (*as per the DCU Child Protection Unit webpage*)
☐ We confirm that we have put in place safeguards for the children participating in the research
☐ We confirm that we have supports in place for children who may disclose current or historical abuse (whether or not this is the focus of the research)
☐ We confirm that all requirements will be met prior to commencing the research *(e.g. TUSLA Children First Training completed, Garda Vetting in place)*

2.8 Please confirm how the results of the research will be disseminated:
Include a statement on whether the participants will be provided with any information as to the findings or outcomes of the project

The results of this research will be documented in our test documentation and will only be used for potential improvements to our system. As such it will only be disseminated via submission of said documentation as part of the project.

SECTION 3 – ETHICAL ISSUES AND RISK MANAGEMENT

3.1 Please identify all issues including ethical issues which may arise in the course of this research. What are the potential risks to participants, and how will those risks be addressed or minimised?

Potential risks can be physical, psychological, social, legal, etc. Please include details of any additional support being provided for participants during/after the study

The research for our project is low-risk when it comes to the participants where our primary considerations relate to privacy and data protection, as well as informed consent.

There are no anticipated physical, psychological or social risks involved. Participants are not required to disclose sensitive information, and will only be required to use sample calendars specifically created for this purpose (ie. no personal calendars will be used)

To minimise risk, participants will be fully informed about the purpose of the tests and how exactly they will be involved. Participation is of course voluntary and anyone may withdraw at any time without any type penalty whatsoever. Any personal data collected will be limited to what is strictly necessary for evaluation, stored securely, anonyimised, and handled in accordance with GDPR and the Data Protection Act 2018. No data will be shared with third parties.

3.2 Please identify the potential benefits (direct and/or indirect) to those participating in this research:

Potential benefits should outweigh the potential risks to participants

Participants may benefit indirectly from contributing to the development and evaluation of a smart calendar application designed to improve organisation and usability when managing multiple calendars. Participants may gain insight into how calendar data can be unified across formats and may reflect on their own calendar usage practices.

3.3 Please describe what measures/protocols you have put in place in the event that there are any unexpected outcomes or adverse effects to participants arising from involvement in the research:

As this is a low-risk study, adverse effects are not anticipated. However, if any participant experiences discomfort, confusion, or concern during participation, they will be reminded that they may pause or withdraw from the study at any time without providing a reason.

Any issues raised by participants will be addressed promptly by us, and feedback will be used to improve the system where appropriate. If a data protection or privacy concern arises, data collection will be halted and the issue will be discussed with the project supervisor to ensure appropriate corrective action is taken.

3.4 Do you intend to provide payment or incentives to participants?

Yes ☐	No ☒

If Yes, please consult the REC Guidelines on the Use of Compensation and Incentives (in the Ethics Resources and Guidelines section of the DCU Research Ethics webpage) before providing additional details below

3.5 Does this research raise any potential risks for the researchers themselves?
Please consider the location/environment where the research is being conducted, exposure to distressing data content etc.

Yes ☐	No ☒

If Yes, please describe further and explain what risk management procedures will be put in place to minimise these risks to researchers:

3.6 Does this research raise any potential conflict of interest?
Please consider any potential real or perceived conflicts of interest that might influence the integrity of the research, or give rise to bias in conducting and reporting the research, or affecting publication (consult the DCU Conflict of Interest Policy for assistance)

Yes ☒	No ☐

If Yes, please identify and explain the steps being taken to address that conflict:

This research involves recruiting participants from among friends and family, which may give rise to a perceived conflict of interest. There is a potential risk that participants may feel obliged to participate due to their personal relationship with the researcher, or that responses may be influenced by social desirability bias. To minimise these risks participation will be entirely voluntary, participants will be informed that they may decline or withdraw at any time without consequence, feedback will be collected in a structured manner and, where possible, anonymously, and all data will be reported in aggregate form. The personal relationship between the researcher and participants will not influence data analysis or reporting, and findings will be presented objectively.

3.7 Please describe how the conduct of the research will be monitored:
Regular oversight by the PI is required to ensure the project conforms to the procedures set out in this application (especially where several people are involved in carrying out the research procedures)

The research will be conducted by the two students in accordance with the procedures outlined in this ethics application. Both of us will ensure that all participant interactions follow the approved Plain Language Statement and Informed Consent process. A clear and agreed protocol will be established in advance covering participant recruitment, consent procedures, data collection, and data storage. We will both adhere strictly to this protocol to ensure consistency in the conduct of testing.

All collected data will be securely stored in a shared, access-controlled location accessible only to the two researchers. Data handling and deletion will follow the procedures described in this application.

SECTION 4 – CONFIDENTIALITY AND DATA MANAGEMENT

4.1 Considering your previous response in section 2.3 of the form on data collection, please confirm whether you are collecting or processing personal data in this research project:
Personal data is any information about a living person, where that person is either identified, or could be identified from the data itself, or when it is combined with other data. This includes paper based, electronic and biological samples data. If your data is fully and completely anonymous, it is not personal data.

Yes ☒	No ☐

If Yes, please confirm your compliance with the following by ticking the checkboxes:

☒ We confirm that we have completed the DCU Data Protection training module on Loop.
☒ We confirm that we have read the "Data Protection – Key Points for DCU Researchers" guidance on the DCU Data Protection Unit (DPU) website and agree to protect and manage our data in accordance with same.
☒ We have assessed the degree of risk inherent in the personal data being used in the research project, and confirm that all DPU GDPR requirements have been met prior to submitting this application *(e.g. completion of Data Protection questionnaire, confirmation that any survey tool being used is GDPR compliant, that required Data Processing or Sharing Agreements will be in place, etc.)*

4.2 Data access – please confirm whether access to participant data is confined to the investigators named on this application:

Yes ☒	No ☐

If No, please name who the other individuals are and why they need access. Any proposed transfer of data (including outside of the EU) should be detailed here.

4.3 Data storage – please confirm compliance with the following:

☒ Data collected on mobile devices will be protected with a strong password/passphrase at a minimum, and/or encrypted if the device supports it
☒ Data will be removed from mobile devices as soon as is practicable and stored in a secured location in DCU (on server or institutional Google Drive)
☒ Paper based data will be held securely in locked cabinets in DCU, with access restricted to the named researchers
Specific arrangements in relation to biological samples should be stated here:
Any exemptions to the above compliance statements should be justified here:

4.4 Please confirm who will be responsible for the secure storage of data generated by the research:

Name the relevant DCU investigator/s

The data generated by this research will be securely stored by the two students conducting the project. Both of us will be responsible for ensuring that data is stored securely, access is restricted to us alone.

4.5 Please confirm how long the data will be held for:

For personal data, consult section 15: Retention of Personal Data in the "Data Protection – Key Points for DCU Researchers" guidance on the DCU Data Protection Unit (DPU) website

Personal data collected during this project will be retained only for as long as is necessary to complete the research and assessment requirements. Identifiable personal data will be retained until final project assessment has been completed, and for no longer than 12 months following submission of the project. After this period, all identifiable data will be securely deleted. Where possible, data will be anonymised at an earlier stage. Fully anonymised data may be retained for academic reference purposes as it will no longer constitute personal data.

4.6 Please confirm what will happen to the data collected at the end of the study:

Please tick the relevant checkbox and complete the associated follow-up section for that category

Archived ☐	Destroyed ☒	Other ☐

4.6.1 Archived data

Please provide the following details:

Name the DCU staff member responsible for archival and future use of data	*The two students working on the project will do so. There is no plan for long-term archival beyond this period.*
Confirm whether the data will be made available to other researchers, and if so, how?	*No*
Confirm how the data will be prepared for archive (e.g. will datasets be anonymised)	*Where possible datasets will be anonymised from the very start of testing.*
Confirm where the data will be archived and who will be allowed to access it	*On password-protected personal computers and/or secure access-controlled cloud storage accounts belonging to the two students. Access will be restricted to them alone.*

4.6.2 Destroyed data

Please provide the following details – Note: for student projects, the supervisor must take responsibility for data destruction if there is no guarantee the student will have access to the data at the time of destruction

Please justify why the data will be destroyed	*The data will be destroyed once the retention period has expired because there is no further academic or research purpose for retaining identifiable personal data beyond project assessment requirements. Retention beyond this period would not be justified under data protection principles.*

Name the DCU researcher responsible for destruction of data	*Amaru Előd Frisancho and Theo Robin*
Confirm when the data will be destroyed (specify date)	*1 March 2027*
Confirm compliance with the following destruction methods (tick relevant boxes)	☒ Electronic data will be overwritten/securely deleted ☒ Paper based data will be confidentially shredded ☒ Medical samples will be disposed in accordance with the relevant DCU approved SOP

4.6.2 Other - Please explain what will happen to the data if not being archived or destroyed:

SECTION 5 – PARTICIPANT INFORMATION AND INFORMED CONSENT PROCEDURES

In addition to completing this form you are required to attach, within the single PDF that you submit, a copy of (1) the Participation Information Sheet which you share with your participants and (2) a copy of the Informed Consent Form which your participants sign.

5.1 Please confirm that the following items have been addressed in your Participant Information Sheet which should be shared with all participants whether it involves online or in-person data gathering:

The items below should be used as headings in yourinformation sheet. Note the language used under each item must reflect the participant age group and corresponding comprehension level– if your participants have different comprehension levels (e.g. both adult and child participants) then separate sheets must be prepared for each set. Templates are available via the REC Forms - Applications, Templates and Amendments section of the Research Ethics website.

Checklist – tick the relevant check box for each item	**Yes**	**No**
Introductory Statement (Researcher names and titles, school, title of the research study)	☒	☐
What is this research about?	☒	☐
Why is this research being conducted?	☒	☐
Why have you been invited to take part?	☒	☐
What will happen if you decide to take part in this research study?	☒	☐
How will your data be used?	☒	☐
How will your privacy be protected (including any legal limits to confidentiality)?	☒	☐
What are the benefits of taking part in this research study?	☒	☐
What are the risks of taking part in this research study?	☒	☐
Can you change your mind at any stage and withdraw from this study?	☒	☐
How will you find out what happens with this project?	☒	☐
Contact details for further information	☒	☐

If you marked any item as No, please explain and justify why:

5.2 Informed Consent Procedures – please confirm whether written consent is to be obtained:
Please tick the relevant checkbox

Yes ☒	No ☐

If Yes, describe the procedures by which written consent will be obtained. If you are involving child participants, you will also need to obtain their written assent. Templates are available via the REC Forms - Applications, Templates and Amendments section of the Research Ethics website.

Consent will be obtained via digital signature

If No, describe the procedures regarding how consent/assent will be obtained:

If you are gathering data from an online process such as Google Form or SurveyMonkey then you should use a page such as the one below, to capture participants' informed consent and your data gathering should not proceed until participants have completed this form with the appropriate answers.

Participant – please complete the following (by clicking Yes/No for each question)

I have read the Plain Language Statement (or had it read to me) *

- (●) Yes
- ( ) No

I understand the information provided *

- ( ) Yes
- ( ) No

I have had an opportunity to ask questions and discuss this study *

- ( ) Yes
- ( ) No

I understand the information provided in relation to data protection *

- ( ) Yes
- ( ) No

I have received satisfactory answers to all my questions *

- ( ) Yes
- ( ) No

I understand I may withdraw from the Research Study at any point *

- ( ) Yes
- ( ) No

I have read and understand the arrangements to be made to protect confidentiality of data, including that confidentiality of information provided is subject to legal limitations *

- ( ) Yes
- ( ) No

I have read and understand confirmations relating to any other relevant information as indicated in the PLS *

- ( ) Yes
- ( ) No

I consent to participate in this research study *

- ( ) Yes
- ( ) No

SECTION 6 – SUBMISSION CHECKLIST AND RESEARCHER DECLARATION

6.1 Please confirm all required supplementary documentation to be included in this application within Section 7:

Checklist – tick the relevant check box for each item	Yes	N/A
Participant Information Sheet/s	☒	
Informed Consent Form/s	☒	☐
Informed Assent Form/s	☐	☒
Recruitment Advertisement	☐	☒
Questionnaire/Survey	☐	☒
Interview/Focus Group Questions	☐	☒
Debriefing Material	☐	☒
Bibliography	☐	☒
Approval from another Research Ethics Committee	☐	☒
Evidence of other external approvals (e.g. Board of Management letter)	☐	☒
Evidence of internal approvals (e.g. BSC approval review letter)	☐	☒
Other – provide details here:	☐	☒

6.2 Signed Declaration

By submitting this form, the applicant (and supervisor) agree to the following:

The information contained herein is, to the best of my knowledge and belief, accurate. I have read the University's current research ethics guidelines, and accept responsibility for the conduct of the procedures set out in the attached application in accordance with the form guidelines, the REC guidance and resources, the University's Conflict of Interest Policy, its Code of Good Research Practice and any other condition laid down by the Dublin City University Research Ethics Committee. I have attempted to identify all risks related to the research that may arise in conducting this research and acknowledge my obligations and the rights of the participants.

I also acknowledge my requirement to be informed as to other duties and legal obligations applying to my research, and to comply with these duties and obligations – this includes being informed about DCU Data Protection guidelines for researchers, DCU Child Protection policy and procedures (where relevant) and DCU Insurance requirements.

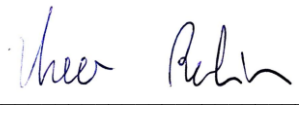
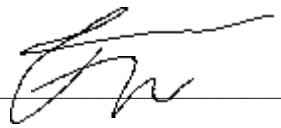
I and my co-investigators and/or supporting staff have the appropriate qualifications, experience and facilities to conduct the research set out in the attached application and to deal with any emergencies and contingencies related to the research that may arise. Research will not commence until required consents and approvals are in place.

Electronic Signature(s):

Supervisor:  _____

*Print Name here:*_____*David Sinclair*_____

Date: _18/02/2026__

Student(s) signature(s):   _____

Print Name(s) here: Theo Robin *Amaru Előd Frisancho*

Date: 18.02.2026

SECTION 7 – SUPPLEMENTARY DOCUMENTATION

Please attach all required documentation as confirmed by you in the previous section. The application should then be saved as one file in PDF format before submission via the project dashboard.

DUBLIN CITY UNIVERSITY
Informed Consent Form – DCU REC Template (approx. 300 words)

Research Study Title

Smart Calendar – Extracting and Organising Scheduling Information into Structured Calendar Events

School of Computing, Dublin City University

Researchers:
Theo Robin (Undergraduate Student)
Amaru Előd Frisancho (Undergraduate Student)

Supervisor:
David Sinclair

Clarification of the purpose of the research

This study evaluates the usability and functionality of a smart calendar application designed to extract and organise scheduling information into structured calendar events.

Dublin City University (DCU) is the Data Controller for this research. Any personal data will be processed solely for the purposes of evaluating the system and completing the researchers' undergraduate project.

Confirmation of particular requirements as highlighted in the Participant Information Sheet

Participant – please complete the following (Circle Yes or No for each question)	
I have read the Participant Information Sheet (or had it read to me)	*Yes/No*
I understand the information provided	*Yes/No*
I have had an opportunity to ask questions and discuss this study	*Yes/No*
I have received satisfactory answers to all my questions	*Yes/No*
I understand what my participation involves	*Yes/No*
I understand that no audio or video recordings will be taken	*Yes/No*
I understand that my participation is voluntary	*Yes/No*
I understand that I may withdraw from the study at any time	*Yes/No*

Confirmation that involvement in the Research Study is voluntary

I understand that taking part in this research study is entirely voluntary. I may withdraw at any stage without consequence.

Confirmation of arrangements to be made to protect confidentiality of data, including that confidentiality of information provided is subject to legal limitations

I understand that:

- *Dublin City University is the Data Controller.*
- *My data will be used only for the purposes outlined in the Participant Information Sheet.*
- *Data will be stored securely on password-protected systems.*
- *Identifiable data will be destroyed by 1 March 2027.*
- *Anonymised data may be retained for academic reference purposes.*
- *Confidentiality is subject to legal limitations.*

Confirmations relating to any other relevant information as indicated in the Participant Information Sheet

I have read and understood the information in this form. My questions and concerns have been answered by the researchers. I have been given a copy of this consent form.

I voluntarily consent to take part in this research project.

Signature:

I have read and understood the information in this form. My questions and concerns have been answered by the researchers, and I have a copy of this consent form. Therefore, I consent to take part in this research project

Participants Signature: _____

Name in Block Capitals: _____

Witness: _____

Date: _____

DCU
Ollscoil Chathair
Bhaile Átha Cliath
Dublin City University

Participant Information Sheet

Introductory Statement

We are Theo Robin and Amaru Előd Frisancho, undergraduate students at Dublin City University (DCU). We are conducting these tests as part of our third year project titled:

“Smart Calendar – Extracting and Organising Scheduling Information into Structured Calendar Events.”

What is this research about?

This research involves testing a smart calendar application designed to help users collect, unify, and organise scheduling information from different sources into structured calendar events.
Our focus is on evaluating how users interact with the system and identifying any usability issues or areas for improvement.

Why is this research being conducted?

The purpose of this research is to evaluate the usability and functionality of our smart calendar system. User feedback will help us improve the application, reduce potential errors, and enhance overall user experience.

This research forms part of our undergraduate degree requirements at DCU.

Why have you been invited to take part?

You have been invited because you have basic computer literacy and regularly use digital tools such as calendars or scheduling applications.

Participation is entirely voluntary. Your decision to participate or not will not affect you in any way.

What will happen if you decide to take part in this research study?

If you agree to participate:

- You will be asked to use the smart calendar application
- You will perform simple tasks such as uploading files, creating/editing/deleting events, and interacting with calendar features
- You will then complete a short questionnaire about your experience

The session will take approximately 10-15 minutes.

No audio or video recording will take place. You will use sample calendar data only — you will not be asked to provide personal calendar information.

How will your data be used?

- *We will collect*
  - *Responses to the usability questionnaire*
  - *Feedback on your experience using the system*
- *Dublin City University (DCU) is the Data Controller.*
- *The research is conducted by Theo Robin and Amaru Előd Frisancho under the supervision of Dr. David Sinclair.*
-

- *You have the right to:*
  - *Access your personal data*
  - *Request correction of inaccurate data*
  - *Withdraw consent (see section below)*
  - *Lodge a complaint with the Irish Data Protection Commission*
- *If you have any data protection concerns, you may contact: Mr. Martin Ward (data.protection@dcu.ie Ph.: 7005118 / 7008257)*
- *Your data will be used solely for evaluating the usability of the smart calendar, and completing our third year project assessment*
- *You have the right to lodge a complaint concerning the use of any personal data with the Irish Data Protection Commission.*
- *Data Protection:*
  - *We have completed DCU Data Protection training.*
  - *Data will be stored securely on password-protected, access-controlled systems.*
  - *Only the named students conducting the tests will have access to the data.*
  - *Data will not be shared with third parties.*
  - *No data will be transferred outside the European Economic Area (EEA)*

How will your privacy be protected (including any legal limits to confidentiality)?
Your responses will be anonymised where possible and reported in aggregate form.

Please note that confidentiality of information can only be protected within the limitations of the law — i.e., it is possible for data to be subject to subpoena, freedom of information claim, or mandated reporting by some professions.

What are the benefits of taking part in this research study?

There are no direct financial benefits.

However, you may:
- *Contribute to the development of a practical smart calendar tool*
- *Reflect on your own calendar usage practices*
- *Gain insight into how scheduling systems are designed and evaluated*

What are the risks of taking part in this study?

This is considered a low-risk study.
There are no anticipated physical, psychological, or social risks. You will not be required to provide sensitive personal information.

If you feel uncomfortable at any time, you may stop immediately.

Can you change your mind at any stage and withdraw from this study?

- *Yes. Participation is entirely voluntary.*
- *You may withdraw at any time without giving a reason and without penalty.*
- *You may request that your data be removed up until the point it has been anonymised or included in final analysis.*

How will you find out what happens with this project?

The results will be included in our third year project submission to DCU.
If you would like a summary of the findings, you may contact us and we will provide one upon project completion.

Contact details for further information:
Theo Robin
Email: theo.robin2@mail.dcu.ie

Amaru Előd Frisancho
Email: amaru.frisancho2@mail.dcu.ie

Supervisor:
David Sinclair
School of Computing
Dublin City University
Email: david.sinclair@dcu.ie

If participants have concerns about this study and wish to contact an independent person, please contact:

The Secretary
Dublin City University Research Ethics Committee
c/o Research and Innovation Support
Dublin City University, Dublin 9
Tel: 01 7008000
Email: rec@dcu.ie